



North Coast Salmon Update #3 – 14 July 2026

Please note that catch numbers and estimates are preliminary and are subject to review.

The 2026/27 Northern Salmon IFMP is available here: [Northern IFMP](#)

North Coast Troll

Coho and Pink Salmon

The Area F troll, A-B Line (North Dixon Entrance), Pink Salmon directed opening ([FN0589](#)) started on July 1st with retention of Coho and Sockeye salmon permitted. Northern Sockeye bycatch provisions are in effect, allowing retention of Sockeye east of 133 degrees W longitude. There are currently 19 vessels hailed into this opening and total effort to July 13th is estimated to be 119 vessel-days. Weekly estimates of effort, catch and releases are summarized in the following table.

Table 1. Area F Troll – 2026 Estimated weekly catch and release by species

WEEK	End Date	Effort	Chinook		Coho		Pink		Sockeye		Chum	
			Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.	Kept	Rel.
27	4-Jul	19	0	68	1,343	0	250	0	1	0	0	10
28	11-Jul	63	0	346	5,098	0	1,954	0	13	0	0	38
29	18-Jul	37	0	166	2,281	5	1,495	8	0	0	0	9
Total		119	0	580	8,722	5	3,699	8	14	0	0	58

Notes: -Effort reported as vessel-days.

-Week 29 only includes the first two days

Due to ongoing concerns and continuing uncertainty regarding North Coast Coho abundance and productivity the Area F full fleet directed mixed stock Coho fishery and Central Coast Limited Coho Demonstration fishery will remain closed again in 2026.

Chinook Salmon

The Area F Chinook Salmon ITQ and Haida Community Based Fishery (CBF) openings are scheduled to start on August 10th with open areas that include portions of PFMAs 1, 101, 2W and 142. Approximately 90 vessels are expected to participate in the full fleet Chinook opening, which closes on September 30. Retention of Coho and Pink salmon will be permitted in this opening and dockside validation of all Chinook landings is mandatory.

Further detail on the Area F troll 2026 Chinook openings will be provided in the next update.

Areas 1 & 2 - Haida Gwaii

Recreational:

Area 1 and 2 recreational catch estimates for June were derived from two data sources, including logbook catch reports from 4 of the 5 five participating fly-in lodges as well as independent estimates of catch and releases generated by the Haida Fisheries creel program, which included



1173 point-of-access interviews recorded at 8 sites. Interview data are used to generate CPUE and fishery activity patterns. Effort estimates are derived from both roving vessel counts and point of access video. Preliminary recreational catch estimates for June are shown in the following table:

Table 2. Preliminary Recreational Catch Estimates, Haida Gwaii

2026 Preliminary estimates of June recreational fishing catch for Haida Gwaii (Areas 1 and 2)

Area	Effort (Boat trips)	Coho	Coho-Rel	Chinook	Chinook-Rel	Pink	Sockeye	Chum	Halibut	Lingcod	Rockfish
1	3,685	2,224	246	4,233	8,292	35	7	271	2,168	2,218	1,214
2E	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2W	589	68	0	1,046	1,515	0	0	7	464	1,456	630
June Total	4,274	2,292	246	5,279	9,807	35	7	278	2,632	3,674	1,844

Note: Catch estimates are preliminary and subject to revision.

North Coast Chinook Management Plan-AABM Recreational Fisheries

Areas 1, 2, 142, and that portion of Area 101 west of 131 degrees 40.0 minutes West longitude:

- May 29, 2026 to July 31, 2026 - one (1) Chinook per day.
- August 1, 2026 to March 31, 2027 - two (2) Chinook per day.

Area 3 - Nass River

The Nass River Gitwinksihlkw fish wheels have been operating since June 1. In-season run size estimates past the fishwheels are shown in Table 1. Updated in-season forecast estimates for the total return to Canada (TRTC) are not yet available and will be provided by Nisga'a Fisheries and Wildlife Department.

Table 2. Nass fishwheel in-season run size estimate to July 12, 2026, and historical average cumulative catch (1994-2025) to date.

Year	Sockeye	Chinook	Coho	Steelhead
2026	158,723	8,742	-	45
1994-2025 Avg.	122,200	16,350	-	40

Data provided by Nisga'a Fisheries and Wildlife Department.

Nass River salmon stock assessment updates from the Nisga'a Fish and Wildlife Department are available by Dropbox [here](#).

Nisga'a Fisheries:

Nisga'a Nation cumulative domestic (FSC) and total catch summary for Nass salmon and steelhead will be included when available.

Net Fisheries:

Area C:

The Area 3 gill net fishery was scheduled for July 6-7. Catch data will be provided as available.



Fishery Operations System

**Commercial SALMON GILL NET In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces)
for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 14-Jul-2026****Management Area 3**[Report Details by Subarea or Portion](#)

Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated
				Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		06-Jul	81	4687	0	0	31	58	0	3059	40	0	41	0	0	Preliminary	08-Jul-2026
		07-Jul	81	4212	0	0	35	136	9	2124	63	0	66	0	1	Preliminary	08-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	162	8899	0	0	66	194	9	5183	103	0	107	0	1		
		Total for Management Area 3 in Period	162	8899	0	0	66	194	9	5183	103	0	107	0	1		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

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Area A:

Area 3 seine opportunities have been announced for July 13-14. Catch data will be provided for the following update.



Fishery Operations System

**Commercial SALMON SEINE In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces)
for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 14-Jul-2026****Management Area 3**[Report Details by Subarea or Portion](#)

Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated
				Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		07-Jul	20	219	0	0	79	78	10	4874	0	0	169	0	0	Preliminary	08-Jul-2026
		08-Jul	20	1930	0	0	370	293	0	17442	0	0	161	0	2	Preliminary	09-Jul-2026
		Total for Week	40	2149	0	0	449	371	10	22316	0	0	330	0	2		
		Total for Management Area 3 in Period	40	2149	0	0	449	371	10	22316	0	0	330	0	2		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

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CSAF Demonstration and Excess to Salmon Spawning Requirements (ESSR) Fisheries:

Two CSAF Demonstration fisheries targeting Nass Sockeye have been included in the 2026 IFMP. The fishery proponents, the Nisga'a Lisims Government and Gitanyow First Nation, have a combined access to 22.75% of the Canadian Commercial Total Allowable Catch for the Nass. Information on these fisheries will become available following implementation.

Two CSAF Demonstration fisheries targeting Area 3 Pink salmon were also included in the 2026 IFMP. North Coast Skeena First Nations Stewardship Society (NCSFNSS), Lax Kw'alaams Band and Metlakatla First Nation have indicated an interest in implementing these fisheries to access 18.63% of harvestable surplus for Area 3 Pink salmon, based on the Area 3 commercial seine harvest. To date these fisheries have not been implemented.



As occurred in 2023 and 2024, ESSR fishing plans that target the harvestable surplus of Meziadin Sockeye are undergoing evaluation for potential implementation in 2026.

Implementation of Demonstration and ESSR fisheries is subject to approval of the respective fishing plans.

Recreational Fisheries:

Non-Tidal

Recreational fishing for Chinook is closed in the Nass River watershed.

North Coast Chinook Management Plan-ISBM Tidal Recreational Fisheries

Areas 3 to 5, 103 to 105, Subarea 102-1, and that portion of Area 101 east of 131 degrees 40.0 minutes West longitude:

- Effective June 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours June 22, 2026 - One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 17, 2026 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.
- Effective July 18, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 31, 2026 – One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective Aug 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 – Two (2) Chinook per day.

Tidal portion of the Gingolx (Kincolith) River:

- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.

Sockeye

Recreational fishing for Sockeye will open in Areas 3, 4 and 5 on July 10, 2026 with a daily limit of four (4).

Meziadin Fishway:

Fishway operations commenced July 1, 2026. As of July 13, a total of 1,816 Sockeye have been counted through (Table 3), compared to the mean 1994-2025 cumulative count to date of 14,326. Water levels were 1.34m (compared to mean 1998-2025 level of 1.32m), and the water temperature was 15.0°C (15.3°C mean 1999-2025).

Table 3. Cumulative Meziadin fishway counts by species to July 13, 2026, compared to historical mean cumulative adult counts to date.

Year	Sockeye	Chinook	Coho	Steelhead
2026	1,816	2	0	0
1994-2025 Avg.	14,326	8	0	0

Historic and 2026 counts are available through:

<http://www.pac.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/fm-gp/northcoast-cotenord/meziadin-eng.html>

**Kwinageese Weir:**

Kwinageese Weir information will be included in future updates as it becomes available.

Alaska Fisheries**District 101 Gillnet Fishery:**

The District 101 (D1) gillnet fishery opened for four days from July 6 through July 10. Catch and effort information is available below (Table 4).

Table 4. Alaska District 101 gillnet harvest and effort (CPUE) for stat week 28 in 2026 and the 10-year average.

Species	District 1 Catch – Week 28 (CPUE)	10-Year Average (CPUE)
Chinook	60 (0.5)	207 (1)
Sockeye	3,000 (25)	2,501 (16)
Coho	200 (2)	651 (4)
Pink	100 (1)	15,677 (98)
Chum	50,000 (417)	32,821 (204)
Effort (boats)	30	40
Fishing Days	4	4

District 104 Seine Fishery:

The District 104 (D4) purse seine fishery opened on Sunday July 5 for 15 hours and again on July 9 with less than 3 boats participating. Catch and effort information is available below (Table 5).

Table 5. Alaska District 104 seine harvest and effort for start week 28 in 2026.

	Chinook	Sockeye	Coho	Pink	Chum	Boats	Hours
July 5, 2026	0	600	600	350	7,000	9	15
July 9, 2026			Confidential			*	15

More information on Southeast Alaskan fisheries is available here:

<http://www.adfg.alaska.gov/index.cfm?adfg=fishing.main>

Area 4 - Skeena River

Based on results from the Tyee test fishery to July 13, the current run size estimates range from 2.00M-6.46M Skeena sockeye (80% certainty), with a mean (point) estimate of 3.284 M (Table 5, Figure 1). The in-season TRTC estimate has been trending downwards and is being monitored carefully to inform fisheries decisions.

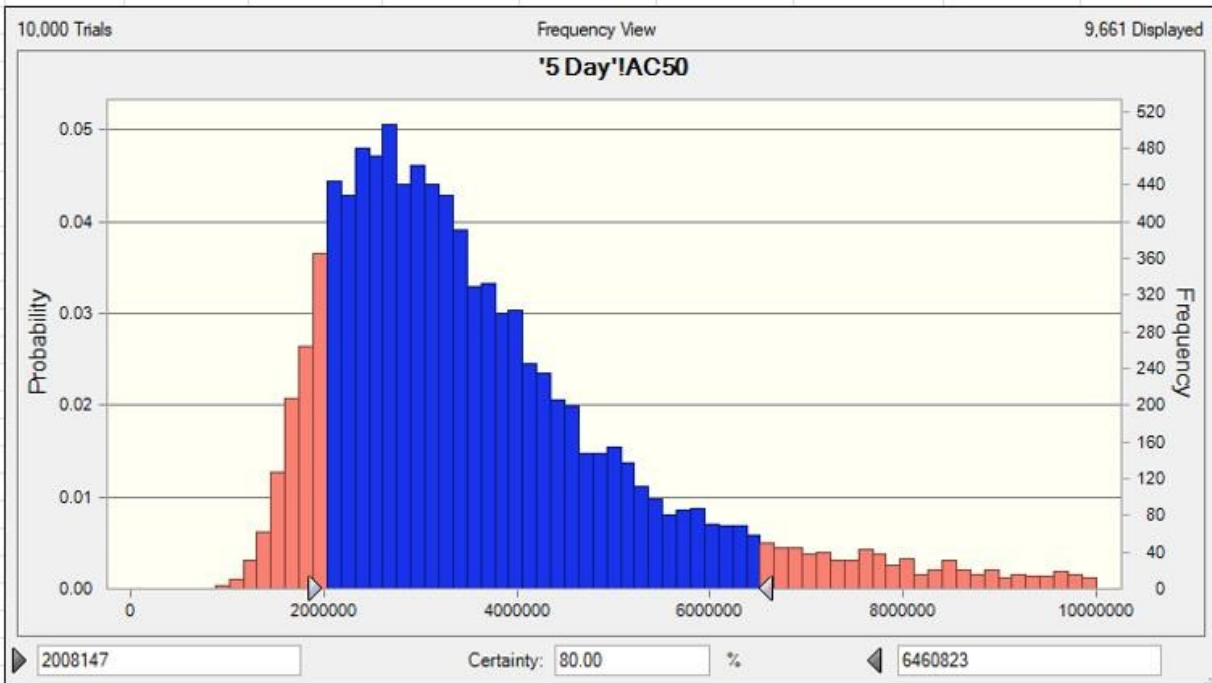
Table 6. 2026 in-season run size estimate probability for Skeena Sockeye as of July 13, 2026.



2026 Inseason TRTC

to July 13

				2026 Inseason Run Size Estimate Prob. (TRTC)				
Species	Stock	Escape Target		Median				
Sockeye	Skeena	1,050,000	TRTC	10%	25%	50%	75%	90%
			Mean			3,284,971		
			Median	6,460,823	4,538,416	3,273,281	2,487,474	2,008,147



TRTC run size probability distribution to July 13, 2026. Shaded areas indicate 80% CI.

Figure 1. Total return to Canada run size probability distribution to July 13 2026. Shaded areas indicate 80% CI.

Tyee Test Fishery:

The test fishery began operation on June 10, 2026. As of July 13, the estimated number of large Sockeye past Tyee is 634,875. Using average run timing (1985-2025), it is estimated that 20.03% of the run has passed Tyee as of this date.

Table 6. Tyee test fishery cumulative index to date July 13, 2026 and ten-year average (2016-2025) to date.

Year	Sockeye	Coho	Pink (even)	Chum	Lg. Chinook	Steelhead
2026	424.23	0.55	0.49	0.63	75.36	8.1
2025	250.09	0	-	0.62	83.99	3.93
2024	332.1	0.1	2.45	0.42	43.45	12.16
2023	383.76	0.12	-	0	68.78	0.88
2022	379.84	0.12	0.19	0	102.34	1.93



2016-2025 Average	198.73	0.13	1.67	0.30	59.55	5.85
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The 2026 Tyee test fishery daily and cumulative Sockeye escapement estimate data, along with 2026 daily and cumulative escapement indices by species, are available here:

<http://www.pac.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/fm-gp/northcoast-cotenord/skeenatyee-eng.html>

Net Fisheries:

Area C:

An opening for Area C occurred July 10-11 with further openings announced for July 13-14 within Area 4. Catch information will be provided as it becomes available.



Fishery Operations System

Commercial SALMON GILL NET In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces) for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 14-Jul-2026

Management Area 4

Management Area 4										Report Details by Subarea or Portion									
Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated		
				Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel				
		10-Jul	114	11463	0	0	71	0	34	0	27	0	133	0	16	Preliminary	13-Jul-2026		
		11-Jul	116	11635	0	0	92	0	44	0	14	0	32	0	8	Preliminary	13-Jul-2026		
		Total for Week	230	23098	0	0	163	0	78	0	41	0	165	0	24				
		Total for Management Area 4 in Period	230	23098	0	0	163	0	78	0	41	0	165	0	24				

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

Printed from the Fishery Operations System on July 14, 2026 at 15:30

Area A:

An Area 4 ITQ opportunity has been announced from July 15-19. Catch information will be provided following.

CSAF Demonstration and Excess to Salmon Spawning Requirements (ESSR) Fisheries:

Seven CSAF Demonstration fisheries targeting Skeena Sockeye were included in the 2026 draft IFMP. North Coast Skeena First Nations Stewardship Society (NCSFNSS), Kitsumkalum Band, Kitselas First Nation, Metlakatla First Nation, Lax Kw'alaams Band, Gitxsan First Nation, and Lake Babine Nation fisheries represent access to 22.75% of the Canadian Commercial Allowable Catch, further divided by geographic access and proponent.

Area 4 marine Demonstration fisheries were implemented July 8, 9, and 12 and catch information is included below (Table 7). Please note catches have been combined to meet privacy requirements. Additional openings will be communicated by fisheries notice.



Table 7. Area 4 CSAF demonstration fishery catches and effort to date.

Date	Area	Effort (# of boats)	sockeye retained	pink retained
8-Jul	4-12 & 4-15	3	129	0
9-Jul	4-9 & 4-12	12	2,227	0
12-Jul	4-12	7	1,326	0
12-Jul	4-5, 4-9, 4-15	6	1,853	0
Total		28	5,535	0

Two ESSRs in the Skeena River watershed were included in the 2026 draft IFMP: Babine Sockeye (Lake Babine Nation) and Bulkley River Pink salmon (Office of the Wet'suwet'en). Openings of these fisheries will be announced via fisheries notice.

Implementation of all CSAF Demonstration fisheries and ESSRs is subject to approval of the respective fishing plans.

Recreational Fisheries:

Area 3 and 4 Creel Survey

May Summary

The North Coast Skeena First Nations Stewardship Society began their creel survey operations in May of 2026. They performed 353 interviews totalling 1,086 anglers with a reported catch of 655 Chinook and 8 Coho. These numbers are expanded to produce a catch (kept) estimate of 2,115 Chinook and 41 Coho.

In May of 2025 they performed 301 interviews totalling 891 anglers with a reported catch of 424 Chinook and 9 Coho. These numbers are expanded and produce a catch estimate of 1,105 Chinook and 23 Coho for the month of May.

Non-Tidal

Recreational fishing for Chinook started closed in the Skeena River watershed and all rivers and lakes flowing into PFMA's 3 to 6, excluding the Kitimat River.

Recreational fishing for Sockeye will open on the Skeena River mainstem on July 10, 2026 with a daily limit of two (2).

North Coast Chinook Management Plan-ISBM Tidal Recreational Fisheries

Areas 3 to 5, 103 to 105, Subarea 102-1, and that portion of Area 101 east of 131 degrees 40.0 minutes West longitude:

- Effective June 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours June 22, 2026 - One (1) Chinook per day.
- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 17, 2026 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.
- Effective July 18, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours July 31, 2026 – One (1) Chinook per day.



- Effective Aug 1, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 – Two (2) Chinook per day.

Tidal portion of the Gingolx (Kincolith) River:

- Effective June 23, 2026 at 00:01 hours to 23:59 hours March 31, 2027 - Zero (0) Chinook per day.

Sockeye

Recreational fishing for Sockeye will open in Areas 3, 4 and 5 on July 10, 2026 with a daily limit of four (4).

Kitwanga Weir:

The Gitanyow Fisheries Authority will be operating the Kitwanga Weir again this year. It is typically operational by early July. Updates provided by the Gitanyow Fisheries Authority will be available here: www.gitanyowfisheries.com

Sustut Weir:

The Province of BC will be operating the Sustut Weir this year. It is expected to be operational by August.

Kispiox River:

Water conditions in the Kispiox River, reflective of Drought Management considerations, will be communicated throughout the season.

Area 6

Net Fisheries:

Area A

Opportunities will be determined in-season and any available information will be provided in future updates.

CSAF Demonstration Fisheries

One CSAF demonstration fishery targeting Area 6 Pink salmon was included in the 2026 draft IFMP. Implementation of this fishery is subject to approval of the final fishing plan.

Areas 7 to 10 - Central Coast

Net Fisheries:

There have been five, 24-hour Chinook-directed commercial gill net fisheries in Area 8 to date this season, held on June 1, 8, 15, 22 and 29. Preliminary catch estimates for the Area C gill net fishery are provided below.

The Nuxalk demonstration fishery was opened for 24 hours on July 2, 2026; preliminary catch information is forthcoming. There are no further Chinook-directed commercial gill net openings planned.



Fishery Operations System

**Commercial SALMON GILL NET In-Season Estimated Catch-by-Area (Pieces)
for Area C (Central) and
for Period 01-Apr-2026 to 06-Jul-2026****Management Area 8**[Report Details by Subarea or Portion](#)

Stat Week	Week of Year	Date	Effort	Sockeye Salmon		Coho Salmon		Pink Salmon		Chum Salmon		Chinook Salmon		Steelhead		Status	Last Updated
Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel	Kept	Rel		
		01-Jun	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	0	0	Preliminary	03-Jun-2026
Total for Week			3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	0	0		
		08-Jun	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	23	0	0	0	Preliminary	11-Jun-2026
Total for Week			4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	23	0	0	0		
		15-Jun	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	31	27	0	0	0	Preliminary	18-Jun-2026
Total for Week			5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	31	27	0	0	0		
		22-Jun	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	424	124	0	0	0	Preliminary	25-Jun-2026
Total for Week			9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	424	124	0	0	0		
		29-Jun	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	416	48	0	0	0	Preliminary	02-Jul-2026
Total for Week			5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	416	48	0	0	0		
Total for Management Area 8 in Period			26	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	873	228	0	0	0		

Notes:

1. Consult the applicable Fishery Manager or Biologist as to the status of particular catch estimates.

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Central Coast Recreational Fisheries:

Data will be provided when available later in the season.

As per FN0687; Effective July 10, 2026 at 00:01 hours until 23:59 hours on August 17, 2026. The daily limit for Chinook is zero (0) per day in the tidal waters of Subareas 9-3 to 9-9.

The Heiltsuk, Kitasoo Xai'xais, Nuxalk, and Wuikinuxv Nations, with the coordination of the Central Coast Indigenous Resource Alliance (CCIRA) continue to collect data through a creel survey and DNA sampling program. The program will assess recreational and First Nations' Food, Social, and Ceremonial (FSC) fisheries in marine portions of Areas 6 to 9. Survey work will occur through September 2026. Recreational and Indigenous fishers should be aware that they may be approached by creel surveyors from the Nations to collect important data from these fisheries.